can work them, and their cost is trifling, say $ 570 00/100 for six machines.

Yokei, June 4th 1874.

Respectfully submitted
Chs. W. Legendre

His Excellency
Okuma Shigenobu
Minister of Colonization.
etc. etc. etc.

Memo. No 33.

When, in April last, the news of the intention of Japan to send a mission to Aboriginal Formosa first reached Peking, the Tsung li yamen and the Provincial authorities at Foochow were confident that the English and the American Ministers would be able to prevent its departures. The consequence was that neither the control nor the provincial governments made any preparations to watch the operations of the Japanese forces as they would approach the Chinese settlements that bordered on the Routan country. One of their main points of justification for this neglect probably was that ever since Dutch Formosa was first annexed to the Imperial crown, Aboriginal Formosa has been considered as being outside of the limits of the Empire, and by entering

entering it the Japanese had not threatened Chinese territory. But as the Central Government has lately been induced to believe that the occupation of the Southern end of Aboriginal Formosa by His Imperial Japanese Majesty's forces, had for its object much less the punishment of the Aborigines than the taking of preliminary steps towards the occupation of the whole island, they now make the provincial rulers responsible for all the consequences that may result from the invasion.

In a secret memorial, addressed by Du Kwei, the present President of the Board of War at Peking, to the Empress regent, dated the 9th year of Tung-Chi, 7th moon, 18th day, and a copy of which is in my possession, the following passage occurs:

"at the ports along the coast of
"the Fuh-kyen province, heretofore there
"had been soldiers prepared for defence.
"But since the third year of Tung-che
"the dependence has been on the large
"bodies of soldiers from the provinces
"of Yunnan and Kupeh, to be distri-
"buted in camps or sent on active
"duty as occasion requires. More recent-
"ly, in consequence of deficiency in the
"Treasury, the soldiers have been gradu-
"ally dismissed. At the present time
"there are retained in the important
"places, both of the upper and the
"lower parts of the province, at some
"points only two or three hundred sol-
"diers, and at some only a few tens. In
"all there is not the show of an army."

The Viceroy then having pointed out how he could depend certain parts of his province by aid of the militia

militia, goes on to say:-

"As regards Formosa, it is an "island by itself in the sea, and difficult to Protect. The soldiers are very "few, and the people are easily led "away from loyality. It gives more "anxiety than Foochow and Amoy."

The officer who, at the time the above report was made, was in command of the troops is still in Fuhkyen, occupying his old position of Tartar General and superintendent of Customs. He is an officer of the first rank, very old, and a relation of the Emperor.

The fears which, in 1870, the Imperial government entertained of a war breaking out with France, on account of the Tientsin massacre, and which had led to the inquiries that brought forth the memorial quoted above

above, were soon after allayed by the successful negociations of Chung How, and therefore no change was made in the irregular state of military affairs as they existed at that time, and the province remains as unprotected as ever. This fact will be noted by the Imperial Commissioner when he arrives at Foochow on his way to Formosa to treat with General Saigo. If the difficulties between Japan and China are satisfactorily settled, both the Tartar-General and Viceroy of Fuhkyen will not find it difficult to justify themselves before their Imperial masters. But if they are not adjusted, the Imperial Commissioner will not fail to lay the blame on the shoulders of the Viceroy and Tartar General, who had neglected to place the province in a state of defence. In the latter case the

the penalty to which they will be liable is death.

It clearly results from the above that the Viceroy and Tartar General of Fuh Kyen are more interested than any one else to have these matters adjusted; and if Japan, through her Commissioner, does not make excessive demands upon these officers, it is evident that they will make all possible efforts to have these demands granted at Peking.

What can be these demands?

First:- Japan can claim that, as Southern Aboriginal Formosa does not by right belong to China, since she (Japan) has conquered it, she is entitled to keep it.

Second:- If, on the contrary, Japan concedes that she has gone to Southern Formosa simply to take reprisals for

for the murder of the Lewchewans and to inaugurate measures to prevent the recurrence of such tragedies on that coast, she can say to China that she will return to her the conquered territory on certain conditions, one of which might be the payment of an indemnity.

If the settlement to be arrived at between Japan and China is to be made according to the first demand, then the negociator sent to Foochow will need to show the agents of the Emperor there, that they may in turn show to their Imperial master, that it is to the interest of China that Japan should occupy that country. In support of this view, he might make use of the arguments submitted to Your Excellency in my letter of the 30th of June last, forwarding

ding my Memo of No. 32.

But if a settlement in accordance with the second demand be desired, I believe that the sending of an iron-clad to Foochow, and of another to Amoy, would be a great aid to the provincial authorities. For in this case, they would simply have to protect themselves against any damaging disclosures by the Imperial Commissioner, concerning the poor state of defence in which the province has been allowed to remain, by securing his silence by bribery, and entering into a league with him to represent at Peking that if the landing of the Japanese at Tsiaiao was not resisted, it was simply because of the want of iron-clads to cope with those sent by Japan to blockade their ports and prevent the sailing of transports

transports with troops for Formosa. They would thus become accusers instead of defendants; and they would be only too glad to secure the evacuation of Formosa by the Japanese troops by signing a convention, subject to the approval of both governments, whereby they would guarantee to pay to Japan the expenses of the expedition, and such other indemnities as might be judged equitable. It is not to be doubted that, having once signed this convention, the Chinese Commissioner would find means to have it ratified in Peking.

In the above I have given but a mere outline of the plans by which either of these two settlements might be arrived at. Of course the negociations will demand great management, into the details of which one could not enter without writing volumes

volumes. These details should be left in the hands of the commissioner, to be determined by him according to the circumstances and exigencies of the moment. He should also be allowed to employ, both openly and secretly, any person who, in his judgement, may be of use to him in carrying out his ends.

Tokei, july 6th 1874.

Respectively Submitted
signed Chs. W. Legendre

His Excellency
Okuma Shigenobu
Minister of Colonization
etc. etc. etc.

Private.

Tokei, july 12th 1874

第三拾四号覚書、添翰

Your Excellency

Mr Hirai duly delivered your Excellency's message concerning the copying of certain correspondence, on Friday night; and he mentioned to Mr Davids this morning that the work may be delayed some time longer... I am fully convinced, however, that my departure for Amoy should not be postponed for the want of these documents; and, agreeably to your Excellency's instructions, I have decided to leave Yokohama on the 15th instant, at daylight, by the French mail for Hongkong, where I will take a coast steamer for Amoy. This would give ample time for the iron-clad to reach its destination either at the same time as myself, or very shortly afterwards.

On the other side, the sea trip will

do